

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

cards-stack

Parallel items stacked vertically, full-width cards.

When to reach for cards-stack.

Vertical reading order matters. The audience scans top to bottom, not grid-style. Each card builds on the previous one as the eye moves down the slide.

Each card has more body than a grid card. Two sentences instead of one. cards-grid forces parallel density; cards-stack lets each card breathe with longer body text.

Two to three items, not four-plus. Beyond three cards the slide overflows. For more items, split across multiple slides or switch to cards-grid with shorter text.

Three patterns, each with its own pull.

Inventory. Equal-weight items the audience scans without ordering. The cards-grid family lives here — grid, stack, wide, side.

Comparison. Two or more items weighed against shared criteria. The verdict and compare families live here — they take sides.

Progression. Items that carry an explicit sequence. The list-steps and timeline families live here — order is load-bearing.

Three reasons to keep cards-stack at three items.

1

Cognitive load

Three is the threshold the audience can hold without effort. Past three, the slide demands working memory the room shouldn't have to spend.

2

Vertical real estate

Each stacked card needs ~30% of the slide height to breathe. Four cards force you to shrink the cards until they stop reading as cards.

3

Build path symmetry

cards-stack pairs with cards-grid (3-4 items) and cards-wide (3-4 rows). Keeping cards-stack at 2-3 keeps the family's choices clean.

When NOT to reach for cards-stack.

Four or more items. The stack overflows past three. For four parallel items reach for cards-grid four; for richer per-item bodies, cards-wide handles three or four rows.

One-line cards. If each card is a single short phrase, the stack reads as a padded list. Drop to `list` or `tldr` and reclaim the vertical space.

Forced sequence. Cards-stack is parallel content read in vertical order, not a numbered sequence. For explicit steps, use list-steps or list-criteria.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

- `cards-grid` — three or four parallel items in a scannable grid
- `cards-wide` — three or four rows with more substantial per-card body
- `cards-side` — exactly two items in left-right balance
- `list-steps` — items carry an explicit, ordered sequence